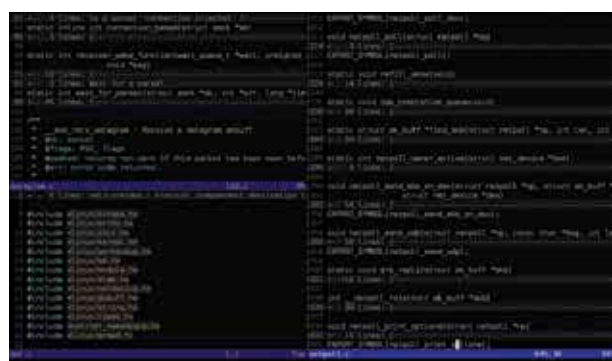


The Definitive Vim Cheatsheet

Master one of the most versatile text editors with the help of this cheatsheet

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We're not here to settle the age old debate of which is the better text editor on Linux, Vim or Emacs. If you're at that point then you've probably mastered both text editors already. This cheatsheet is for the folks who are new to Linux and haven't gotten their bearings around the versatile operating system. Like Linux, Vim (or Vi IMproved) is an extremely versatile text editor that you'll have to use sometime or the other. While it does have a GUI, by modern standards it's as good as having no UI and the editor has very much remained the same since it was first unveiled in 1991. Moving about the



Vim in a terminal emulator

interface happens with the keyboard and practically every action that you would perform in a modern text editor with a GUI has some shortcut or the other. And mastering them will help you learn your way around Vim, and subsequently Linux.

GLOBAL

These are the basic key shortcuts that you need to learn to open up the manual page, get syntax for commands and open or close panes within the editor:

:h[elp] keyword - open help for keyword

:sav[eas] file - save file as
:clo[se] - close current pane
:ter[minal] - open a terminal window
K - open man page for word under the cursor

*Note - Remember to run **vimtutor** in a terminal to learn the first Vim commands.*

CURSOR MOVEMENT

While the cursor movement in Windows might seem intuitive to most of you, you should realise that these operating systems came into their own separately and users of the two operating systems have different ideas when you're talking about intuitiveness. A good way to learn the following is to visualise these shortcuts on the keyboard while reading about them and you'll draw some parallels with what you already know.

h - move cursor left
j - move cursor down
k - move cursor up
l - move cursor right
H - move to top of screen
M - move to middle of screen
L - move to bottom of screen
w - jump forwards to the start of a word
W - jump forwards to the start of a word (words can contain punctuation)
e - jump forwards to the end of a word
E - jump forwards to the end of a word (words can contain punctuation)
b - jump backwards to the start of a word
B - jump backwards to the start of a word (words can contain punctuation)
% - move to matching character (default supported pairs: '()', '{}', '[]' - use **:h matchpairs** in vim for more info)
O - jump to the start of the line
^ - jump to the first non-blank character of the line
\$ - jump to the end of the line
g_ - jump to the last non-blank character of the line
gg - go to the first line of the document
G - go to the last line of the document
5gg or **5G** - go to line 5
gd - move to local declaration
gD - move to global declaration
fx - jump to next occurrence of character x
tx - jump to before next occurrence of character x